One Weekend at a Time

A single-image post · 1080×1350 (4:5) · a photographic still life, no people · lead generation across Manchester and the North West

CONCEPT

The idea

A family wall calendar, pinned to a warm peach kitchen wall. It is full of ordinary life: a swim at 6pm, Bonfire Night, the dentist, book club, a training session. Two weekends are circled in orange marker. The first says **"Pancakes + park"**. Two weeks later, the second says **"Pancakes again!"**

That second note tells the whole story without showing a child: the same young person came back, and they already know what they like at your house. It is respite fostering, which the website describes as planned short breaks: **"one night, a weekend or part of a school holiday"**, where **"some respite carers support the same child regularly so trust can grow."**

HEADLINE
Some fostering happens one weekend at a time.

CALL TO ACTION
Talk to us about respite fostering · 0161 241 1332

What I found on the website

- **The respite page** (organicfostering.co.uk/respite-placements): "Respite foster care, sometimes called short-break fostering, provides planned care for a child over a limited period." It may give "a full-time fostering family time to rest".
- **Who it suits:** "Respite fostering may suit people who can offer regular weekends or planned periods but are not available for full-time care."
- **No shortcuts:** "Respite carers complete the same assessment, checks and training as other foster carers." The site also says it "remains a professional fostering role", so the post never calls it part-time.
- **Payment:** "Respite carers receive payment for the period a child stays with them." Rates depend on the arrangement, so no figure is used.

Why it works

- **It reaches a new audience.** People who ruled fostering out because they can't offer full-time care. No earlier post speaks to them.
- **Everyone owns this calendar.** "Family command centre" calendars are among the most saved home ideas on Pinterest, so the image feels familiar before it is read.
- **The story is in the handwriting.** "Pancakes again!" shows trust growing, with no child on screen and nothing to identify.
- **It is honest.** "Some fostering" and the subline make clear this is one type of fostering, with the same checks and training.
- **It invites comments.** The caption asks: "What did a perfect weekend look like when you were ten?"

Why it's new, and what Pinterest showed

Respite fostering has only appeared as one tile in "Which Foster Carer Are You?"; this is its first post of its own, and the first calm, object-led photo since "Two Toothbrushes". Logged-out Pinterest searches ("fostering instagram post", "family wall calendar aesthetic", "charity social media post minimal photo") showed fostering posts built on sad children's faces, silhouettes, statistics and long quote cards. **We avoid all of those.** We borrow the kitchen-calendar photo from home-organising pins, and the single object with one line of type from minimal charity posts.

LAYOUT PREVIEW

A sketch at 30% of the real size (1 px here ≈ 3.3 px in the post). The final image is a real photograph or an AI background, with all text and the logo added in design.



1. **Logo.** The real Organic Fostering logo file (the site's SVG), top left, about 220 px wide. Never AI-generated.
2. **Eyebrow.** "Respite fostering" in a small cream pill, Poppins SemiBold, 27 px.
3. **Headline.** "Some fostering happens *one weekend* at a time." Nunito Black, about 82 px, plum, with "one weekend" in orange. Two lines, left-aligned.
4. **The calendar.** A real paper wall calendar, slightly crooked, held by an orange magnet. The everyday notes ("Swim 6pm", "Dentist", "Training"…) are texture, not copy, so they can be small.
5. **The circled weekends (the hero detail).** Orange marker. "Pancakes + park", then "Pancakes again!" two weeks later: the same child returning, trust growing. About 30 px tall at full size.
6. **Subline.** "Respite fostering gives a child planned short breaks: one night, a weekend or part of a school holiday." Nunito Bold, 30 px.
7. **Sign-off.** The site's gradient pill, "Talk to us about respite fostering", the phone number and web address (so it works on Facebook too) and "Rated Good by Ofsted". All 26 px or larger.

VISUAL DIRECTION

- **Look:** a warm, honest still life in late-afternoon window light. One object, lots of calm space.
- **No people.** No children, hands or faces. The handwriting carries the story, so nobody can be identified.
- **Colour:** peach wall (#FFD4BA family), cream paper (#FFFDFB), plum text (#5B174F), orange marker and magnet (#FF6411); the site's magenta-to-orange gradient on the button only.
- **Type:** Nunito, the website's font, for the headline and subline; Poppins for small labels; real handwriting on the calendar (or Caveat if it is added digitally).
- **Dates:** use the month you post in. The mock shows November 2026 (Bonfire Night is Thursday 5th); change dates and notes to match a real calendar.
- **Safe area:** text and logo at least 60 px from every edge; the 3:4 profile grid trims about 34 px a side, so nothing is lost.
- **Story size (1080×1920):** extend the wall; keep text out of the top 250 px and bottom 340 px.

HOW TO MAKE IT

- **Photo route (best, about an hour):** write the notes on a real wall calendar, circle two weekends in orange marker and photograph it on a peach wall by a window. Add the headline, subline, sign-off and logo in Figma or Canva.
- **AI route:** generate the wall and a *blank* calendar only (AI garbles numbers and handwriting), then add dates, notes, circles and copy in design. Turn on the "AI info" label. Prompt:

> Photoreal still life, 4:5. A plain paper wall calendar with an empty grid, pinned slightly crooked to a warm peach-painted kitchen wall with one round orange magnet. Soft late-afternoon window light from the right, a faint window-frame shadow, cream matte paper with a slight curl, a pen hanging on a string. Calm empty wall above for a headline. Natural colour, warm, editorial. No people, no hands, no text, no numbers, no logos.

POST CONTENT

On-image text

- **Eyebrow:** Respite fostering
- **Headline:** Some fostering happens one weekend at a time.
- **Calendar notes:** Pancakes + park · Pancakes again! (plus the everyday notes)
- **Subline:** Respite fostering gives a child planned short breaks: one night, a weekend or part of a school holiday.
- **Sign-off:** Talk to us about respite fostering · 0161 241 1332 · organicfostering.co.uk · Rated Good by Ofsted

Hashtags (5)

#OrganicFostering #RespiteFostering #FosterCarer #FosteringUK #Manchester

Alt text

A family calendar on a peach kitchen wall, full of everyday notes. Two weekends are circled in orange: “Pancakes + park” and, later, “Pancakes again!”. Text reads: “Respite fostering. Some fostering happens one weekend at a time. Respite fostering gives a child planned short breaks: one night, a weekend or part of a school holiday. Talk to us about respite fostering, 0161 241 1332, organicfostering.co.uk. Rated Good by Ofsted.” The Organic Fostering logo is top left.

Instagram caption

Some fostering happens one weekend at a time. 🧡

Respite fostering, sometimes called short-break fostering, is planned care for a child over a limited period: one night, a weekend or part of a school holiday.

It can give a full-time fostering family time to rest. And some respite carers support the same child regularly, so trust can grow (pancakes optional).

Respite carers complete the same assessment, checks and training as other foster carers, and receive payment for the period a child stays with them.

Can’t offer full-time care, but could offer planned weekends? Talk to us about respite fostering: link in bio or call 0161 241 1332.

What did a perfect weekend look like when you were ten? 👇

Facebook version: the same caption, with the call to action changed to “Talk to us about respite fostering: organicfostering.co.uk/respite-placements or call 0161 241 1332.”

Pinned comment

“Wondering how respite would fit around your life? A member of our Manchester team will explain the next step without pressure or obligation: organicfostering.co.uk/respite-placements”

Story follow-up

Share it to Stories with a poll, “Had you heard of respite fostering?” (Yes / Not until now), and a link sticker to /respite-placements.

COPY CHECK AND SOURCES

- **Every fact is from organicfostering.co.uk, checked 31 October 2026:** /respite-placements (the definition, the stay lengths, “some respite carers support the same child regularly so trust can grow”, who it may suit, the same assessment, checks and training, payment, and “without pressure or obligation”) and the homepage (“Short breaks that support children and their carers”, “Rated Good by Ofsted · Inspected May 2025”, the phone number).
- **No figures and no promises.** No rate is shown (respite rates depend on the arrangement), and nothing implies anyone will be approved or matched.
- **Not “part-time”.** The site says respite “remains a professional fostering role”, so the post avoids that word.
- **Advertising:** no personal-attribute wording, so it can run as a standard Meta ad. The notes are fictional; no real child or family is shown or described.
- **Before posting:** check the dates match the month you post in, and that the bio link goes to /respite-placements.